

Yuxuan Zhu

Second-year Ph.D. student at UIUC CS.

yxx404@illinois.edu ◇ <https://yuxuan18.github.io/>

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Efficient and theoretically grounded computer systems for data management and analysis.

EDUCATION

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign 2023 — present
Ph.D. in computer science
Advisor: [Daniel Kang](#)

University of Michigan 2021 — 2023
Bachelor of Science and Engineering, Computer Science

Shanghai Jiao Tong University 2019 — 2023
Bachelor of Science, Electrical and Computer Engineering

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign 2023 — present
Advised by Prof. [Daniel Kang](#).

- Approximate query processing with joins over unstructured data.
- Built **PilotDB**, a database-agnostic online approximate query processing system with a priori error guarantees.

Symbiotic Lab, University of Michigan 2022-2023
Advised by [Fan Lai](#) and Prof. [Mosharaf Chowdhury](#).

- Built **FedTrans**, a personalized on-device distributed ML training system.

Michigan Intelligent Programming Lab, University of Michigan 2021-2023
Advised by Prof. [Xinyu Wang](#).

- Developed **SlabCity**, a whole-query optimization system leveraging program synthesis.

PUBLICATIONS

- **Yuxuan Zhu**, Tengjun Jin, Stefanos Baziotis, Chengsong Zhang, Charith Mendis, Daniel Kang. “Database-Agnostic Online Approximate Query Processing with A Priori Error Guarantees” *SIGMOD* (2025)
- **Yuxuan Zhu**, Daniel Kang. “Efficient Approximate Query Processing with Block Sampling” *CIDR* (2025)
- **Yuxuan Zhu**, Jiachen Liu, Fan Lai, Mosharaf Chowdhury. “FedTrans: Efficient Federated Learning via Multi-Model Transformation” *MLSys* (2024)
- Rui Dong, Jie Liu, **Yuxuan Zhu**, Cong Yan, Barzan Mozafari, Xinyu Wang. “SlabCity: Whole-Query Optimization using Program Synthesis” *PVLDB* (2023)
- Shijing Yuan, Jie Li, **Yuxuan Zhu**, Chentao Wu, Yue Ding. “An Energy-efficient Computing Offloading Framework for Blockchain-enabled Video Streaming Systems” *GlobeCom* (2022)
- Shijing Yuan, Jie Li, Jinghao Liang, **Yuxuan Zhu**, Xiang Yu, Jianping Chen, Chentao Wu. “Sharding for Blockchain based Mobile Edge Computing System: A Deep Reinforcement Learning Approach” *GlobeCom* (2021)

AWARDS

- **Winner** of Microsoft Student Hackathon - Hack for Education (AI&ML). Nov. 2021
- **Final List Award** in [The Interdisciplinary Contest in Modeling](#). May. 2021
- **Nominee** for **Tang Junyuan Scholarship**. Aug. 2021
- **Grand Prize** in [School-enterprise Joint Creative Contest Organized by Media](#). Nov. 2020
- **Bronze Medal** in University Physics Competition. Dec. 2020
- **Scholarship for Excellent Academic Performance**. Dec. 2020
- **Excellent Young Volunteer** in admission activities of SJTU. Sep. 2020
- **Honorable Mention** by **Judgers** in COVID-19 Challenges Competition. Jul. 2020

OTHER EXPERIENCES

- Grader of MATH 417 Matrix Algebra 2022